Listening to Young Lives at Work: COVID-19 Phone Survey

FIRST CALL

TALKING TO THE YOUNG LIVES RESPONDENTS: CONSENT PROCESS AND FURTHER ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

June 2020

Young Lives

Instructions for the enumerators: The "first call" refers to the first component of the telephone survey, which will take place between June and July. The instrument of the first call includes (i) an initial dialogue,(ii) a questionnaire, (iii) a farewell dialogue, and (iv) comments section. Consent is requested in the initial dialogue.

The first call is the most critical, as it is our first attempt to approach YL families in circumstances that are stressful for everyone. In fact, one of the goals of the first call is to give participants the opportunity for their voices to be heard , and to understand whether it is feasible to ask them to participate in a more detailed survey later ("second call" and "third call").

Note the following:

1. You must use the dialogue guidelines included in the questionnaire in the SurveyBe software.
2. You must ask the questions that are part of the questionnaire.
3. At the same time, you should use your experience to make the conversation flow as naturally as possible. For example, if the young individual tells you something that answers one of the questions you were going to ask, don't ask the question anymore. The idea is that the "first call" should flow as a conversation and not as a survey.
4. It is very important that the young individual feels listened to.

Regarding call content:

1. After the introduction, the Enumerator will explain that Round 6 of the survey has been postponed under the unprecedented circumstances and provide a brief overview of the objective of the YL telephone survey.
2. Before moving forward to ask for the respondent's consent to participate, the Enumerator must confirm they are talking to the right respondent. The Enumerator will then inform the respondent of the duration of the survey and reassure the respondent that all information they provide will be treated confidentially as was done with the information they gave us each time we visited them during the 16 years of the study. Finally, the Enumerator will ask if he/she is willing to participate, assuring the respondent that he will be able to withdraw from the study at any time, without affecting the continued participation in the Young Lives study.
3. If the respondent consents, the Enumerator will record consent and proceed with the survey.
4. At the end of the first call the Enumerator will remind the respondent that he/she will call back in August, to ask him/her if he/she is willing to participate in the main phone survey.
5. The Enumerator should mention that in return for the present that was given in gratitude for his time in the visits of previous years, on this occasion, that we cannot visit him, at the end of the survey he will be given a small compensation equivalent to the price of the present.
6. If the respondent refuses to participate, the Enumerator will ask for the reason for the rejection and try to address it. If the respondent still refuses, the Enumerator will thank for their time. **See Questionnaire for more details on this aspect.*

How to respond to the young individual's concerns

During the conversation, the young individual may ask you questions about various aspects, such as how to collect the government economic support (bono universal), how to protect himself/herself from the coronavirus, how to look for work in these difficult circumstances, or how to access educational scholarships. Refer to **the consultation guide to answer questions.**

How to respond to requests for financial aid

If the index individual asks for financial aid, it is important to distinguish whether this is due to an immediate emergency or not. If it corresponds to an immediate emergency of an economic nature (health or hunger situation), take into account what is mentioned in the following numeral? Otherwise:

- ✓ Mention that "the project does not handle money". This is true, because the financial reward to be given corresponds to the cost of the gift that was to be given to them in this year's face-to-face visit (which was cancelled)
- ✓ Tell the individual about some of the resources in the consultation guide that might help.

[Peru and India only] It might be the case that due to the current crisis, the respondent, upon learning that there will be financial compensation later, asks for this compensation to be given now. In this case, the Enumerator should tell the respondent that they will need to ask him/her some questions to better understand the magnitude of his/her needs/problems and ask for authorization for the advance delivery of the reward and once the Enumerator has the answer he/she will call the respondent again.

The Enumerator must use the "Economic Compensation Information Sheet" to take note of the respondent's savings account or the person he or she designates (Full name of the account holder; DNI; Name of the bank; Account number; Interbank account number if the bank is not BCP). In the event that the respondent does not have a bank account, then the Bank order (Giro Bancario) option will be used to the bank that the respondent designates.

Facing an immediate emergency

Health Emergency:

It could be that at the time of calling the home, they are facing a health emergency, related to COVID-19 or otherwise. In this situation, the protocol should be:

i. Pay attention and take note of the details of the case.
ii. Provide the young individual with the information available in the consultation guide.
iii. Immediately inform the field coordinator to decide what the follow-up will be.

You may be tempted to help with specific recommendations; however, medical recommendations should be left to health experts.

Food emergency:

It could be that at the time of calling home, they are going hungry due to lack of work. In this situation, the protocol should be:

i. Pay attention and take note of the details of the case.
ii. Provide the young individual with the information available in the consultation guide.
iii. Immediately inform the field coordinator to decide what the follow-up will be.

Mental health and suicidal thoughts:

If a respondent feels desperate and suicidal, you should:

iv. Pay attention, listen and keep a quiet conversation. Take note of the details of the case.
v. Provide the young individual, carefully, with the information available in the consultation guide.
vi. Immediately inform the field coordinator to decide what the follow-up will look like.

However, if you feel that you are currently dealing with a real emergency, act as quickly as possible and ask to speak with another family member so that you can tell him/her to seek immediate support. If the respondent sounds suicidal, confidentiality becomes secondary (avoiding harm is more important).

Possible ethical cases

If the Enumerator notices something that causes him/her concern regarding the index individual/family (e.g. related to mental health, poor physical health, hunger, domestic violence) they should record it in the Comments section.

Possible ethical cases should be reported as soon as possible to the Field Coordinator and discussed in weekly feedback sessions. In turn, the Principal investigator will report these cases to the team at Oxford. It is very important that these cases are reported.

From the call 1 questionnaire:

Start the dialogue with the *YL Individual* with the following:

Dialogue 1:

Hello, (are you) / is this [YL Child´s name] ? Hi, I am [first and last name of ENUMERATOR], of the Young Lives Study. The last time I spoke to you [or my partner [say the name of the ENUMERATOR who did the tracking] talked to you] was in [DATE OF TRACKING] [mention if it was by phone or if you visited them at home], do you remember?

On that occasion we told you that a new Round of the study was starting and that from [DATE OF ROUND 6] we were going to visit you again. You agreed and we were very happy. To our regret, we are unable to visit you due to the Health Emergency/Coronavirus/COVID-19. We hope that you and your family are safe and that this situation will get better, which is why we plan to visit you next year and meet you again.

Q.I1: SAY: [YL Child´s name], you know what emergency I´m referring to? I am talking about the Corona virus/COVID-19 pandemic, do you know what I'm talking about, right?

This is a filter question to determine if the *YL Individual* is aware of the current pandemic and the Corona Virus. If s/he says yes, continue to Dialogue 3.

- If s/he says No/is not sure/does not know about the emergency and/or the Corona Virus/Covid-19=00, then read Dialogue 2 before continuing on to Dialogue 3:

Dialogue 2:

"...it is a virus that is transmitted very fast, in some people it causes a serious and dangerous respiratory disease and some of them end up dying. This is why we are in a situation of National Emergency.(and that is why we are concern to know how you and your family are…)"

Now, say the following:

Dialogue 3:

[*YL Child´s name*], about this topic, I will like to talk to you a little bit more, for about 15 minutes, so that you can tell me how you are and also how the people you live with are dealing with all this situation that the Corona virus/Covid-19 has caused.

You know that everything you tell me is confidential, (as it has been with the information you gave us during the 16 years that you have participated in the Young Lives Study).

You also need to know and keep in mind that the information we are collecting from you and the other Young Lives Children in our country will help the authorities of the government and our health system to know how to better prevent and deal with these types of emergencies, for the benefit of the entire population.

Q.I2: [*YL Child´s name*], do you agree? Will you give me your consent?

This question aims to obtain verbal consent from the *YL Individual* to continue with the survey. If s/he says:

- Yes = 01 → skip to *Section 2 (the Survey)*
- No = 00, continue to *Q.I3.*

Q.I3: Why don't you want to participate?

This question aims to understand the reasons as to why the *YL Individual* does not want to give his/her consent. This is particularly important to understand whether the reason why he/she does not want to participate can be addressed.

There are three responses to choose from the dropdown list. Do not prompt the *YL Individual*. Enter the response closest to the *YL Individual's* answer.

- (01) If s/he says s/he does not have the time to do the survey because of current commitments such as studying or having to go to work → *continue to Q.I4.*
- (02) If s/he has doubts and/or does not trust s/he will provide good responses → *skip to Q.I5.*
- (03) If s/he refuses to participate because of a very delicate situation linked to a health, economic or other type of emergency → *skip to Farewell F3*.

Q.I4: Explain that you can call again the day and time that is more convenient for her/him… and also, mention again that it will be a conversation of no more than 15 minutes…

SAY: Would you like to participate? Do you give us your consent to go ahead?

This question is to re-clarify with the *YL Individual* whether there is a more convenient time to call him/her instead if s/he is currently busy. Please note the protocol when you call them back at the agreed time and date. Mark Yes or No based on their response.

- If s/he says Yes=01 → go to *Farewell F2* to schedule a time for the next call and. When you call the *YL Individual* again at the scheduled time and date, start with Q.I2 again to check for their consent before proceeding with the survey.
- If s/he says No=00 → take note of the reason and skip to *Farewell F1*.

Q.I5: Explain again the Purpose of the conversation ..., the confidentiality of what they tell you and the importance that it has, (for the future of the Health system in our country), that they share their experience along with the experience of other young people of the Young Lives study, in this national emergency situation with this new "Coronavirus" the Covid-19 pandemic /….

SAY: What do you think? Would you like to participate?
This question is to re-clarify the goal of the survey and the confidentiality of the responses to allay the *YL Individual's* concerns.

- If s/he says Yes=01 → skip to Section 2 *(the Survey)*
- If s/he says No=00 → move on to *Farewell F1.*

Farewell F1:

Dialogue 4:

[YL Child´s name] don´t worry, your decision is absolutely free and voluntary, we understand and respect it and is necessary that you know that choosing not to participate in this "conversation" doesn´t affect at all your link with Young Lives because you are still an important part of the study until you decide, that is why is important and necessary that you know that in [DATE OF PHONE SURVEY SECOND CALL], I will call you again, not just to find out how you and your family are, but also to inform you, in more detail, that Young Lives, in [DATE OF PHONE SURVEY SECOND CALL] will call all the young people that are part of the study, all over the country, to invite them to participate in a survey with questions related to the Covid-19 / Corona virus, the COVID-19 Response and the national emergency, and its effects on the health, education, economy and work of each young participant and their household's. The entire survey takes approximately 30 minutes. As always, the survey will be done with the consent of each young person and on the day and time that (he / she indicates?) is most convenient for them according to their activities….

Once the *YL Individual* has given his/her consent, ask him/her the following questions in this section. This section aims to collect information about the *YL Individual* and his/her household's health and economic situation since the pandemic, as well as his/her knowledge about symptoms, transmissions and precautions related to the Corona Virus.

Enumerator Statement (included at the end of the survey)

This section is for you (the enumerator) to declare that you have:

- complied with the consent process
- informed the Young Lives participant about everything related to the survey
- read the consent text
- Answered all of the Young Lives participant's doubts, questions and/or queries and that
- You regulate your conduct in accordance with the requirements of the Young Lives Code of conduct (see section 6).

After reading the statement, and if it is true, fill in your details including your full name in capital letters, your national ID number, the full name of the YL participant and the national ID number of the YL participant where applicable.